

3-Mark Questions & Answers — DBMS Module 3: SQL Standards & Advanced Queries

Q1. Explain SQL Set Operations (UNION, INTERSECT, EXCEPT / MINUS).

- UNION / UNION ALL** : Combines result sets of two queries. **UNION** removes duplicates; **UNION ALL** retains all rows.
- INTERSECT** : Returns only rows returned by both queries.
- EXCEPT (or MINUS in Oracle)**: Returns rows from first query that are not present in second query.

Q2. Explain SQL Aggregate Functions with examples.

- COUNT(*) / COUNT(col)** : Counts total rows or non-null values.
- SUM(col) / AVG(col)** : Calculates sum or arithmetic mean of numeric columns.
- MIN(col) / MAX(col)** : Finds smallest or largest value.
- Example:* `SELECT Dept_ID, AVG(Salary) FROM Emp GROUP BY Dept_ID HAVING COUNT(*) > 5;`

Q3. What are Stored Procedures vs Functions in PL/SQL?

Feature	Stored Procedure	Stored Function
Return Value	May return zero, one, or multiple values via OUT parameters.	MUST return exactly one value using RETURN clause.
Invocation in SQL	Cannot be called directly inside SELECT queries.	Can be embedded directly inside SELECT and WHERE clauses.
DML Operations	Allowed to execute INSERT , UPDATE , DELETE .	Restricted from performing DML when used in SELECT .